Quadreria
STUDIO

# How to Choose Your First Collection's Garments

( WITHOUT GUESSING )

A SHORT GUIDE FOR FOUNDERS BUILDING THEIR FIRST DROP.

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# How to Choose Your First Collection's Garments

We've sat through more discovery calls than we can count at this point, and we can tell you the exact moment a founder either has a real collection in their hands, or doesn't. It's not when they pick a logo. It's not when they finalise a brand name. It's the moment they decide what the first collection is actually going to be. And honestly, this is where most people go wrong before they've even started.

Here's the mistake we see more than any other: someone comes to us and says, "I want to launch a streetwear brand, can you design 8 to 10 pieces for me?" And when we ask what those pieces should be, the answer is usually some version of "whatever looks good" or "just a mix, you decide." That's not a collection. That's a guess dressed up as a plan, and guesses are expensive once they reach a factory floor.

So let's talk about how to actually do this properly.

**01 Start with the problem, not the product.**

Every strong first collection solves something specific for a specific person. Not "young people who like streetwear." That's not a problem, that's a demographic. A real starting point sounds more like: "Men in their mid-20s who want relaxed, elevated basics they can wear from a WFH morning straight into evening plans, without looking like they tried too hard." Suddenly you're not just picking garments, you're solving something. That's what makes a collection sellable instead of just wearable.

**02 Pick fewer garments than you think you need.**

We know it's tempting to launch with 15 pieces so the brand "feels complete." We'd push back on that every time. Your first collection should be tight, usually 7 to 10 pieces, each one earning its place. A smaller, sharper collection reads as intentional. A bigger, unfocused one reads as unsure of itself, and customers can feel that even if they can't name it.

**03 Build around a hero piece, not a size chart.**

Every collection we've developed that performed well had one piece doing the heavy lifting: the garment that gets photographed first, worn in every campaign image, and talked about the most. Decide that piece early. Everything else in the collection should support it, not compete with it.

**04 Think in categories a customer actually mixes and matches.**

If your collection can't be worn together, in different combinations, it's not really a collection. It's a pile of individual products. Before you finalise anything, ask: can someone buy three pieces from this drop and wear them in at least two completely different outfits? If not, something's missing, or something's extra.

**05 Stop designing for yourself.**

This one's hard to hear, but it matters. The garments you personally love to wear are not always the garments your target customer wants to buy. We always bring founders back to the person defined in step one. Every single garment decision gets run through that filter: would this specific person actually reach for this?

The founders who skip these steps don't fail because their taste is bad. They fail because they built a collection around vibes instead of a vision. And a vision is something we can actually work with. Vibes, we can't turn into a tech pack.

If you're sitting with a rough idea right now and you're not sure where to start, that's exactly the stage where we love working with founders most. You don't need the whole collection figured out. You just need a real seed of direction, and we can help you grow the rest.

**Reach out at: hello@quadreria.studio**